

TAB 1



Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-291-24/25, **Version:** 1
In Control: Division of Instruction

Agenda Date: 5/13/2025

Adoption of Reading Difficulties Risk Screening Instrument

Division of Instruction

Brief Description:

(Adoption of Reading Difficulties Risk Screening Instrument) Recommends adopting of one state-approved reading difficulties risk screening instrument to screen all kindergarten through second grade students annually for the risk of reading difficulties, including dyslexia, beginning in the 2025-26 school year.

Action Proposed:

In compliance with California Education Code Section 53008, the adoption of Amplify Education's mCLASS with DIBELS 8 (Dynamic Indicators of Basic Early Literacy Skills) and mCLASS Lectura (Spanish language counterpart) as the District's reading difficulties screening instrument for students in kindergarten through second grade; and authorize the Interim Chief Procurement Officer or designee to negotiate and execute a purchase agreement not-to-exceed the amount of \$1.5 million per year for grades Kindergarten, 1 and 2 student licenses, and professional development with Amplify Education for its mCLASS with DIBELS 8 and mCLASS Lectura screening instrument.

Background:

According to the requirements of Education Code Section 53008, beginning with the 2025-26 school year, local educational agencies (LEAs), are required to assess each of their students in kindergarten through grade two for risk of reading difficulties using a Reading Difficulties Risk Screener Selection Panel (RDRSSP) approved screening instrument or instruments. The law requires that the results of the screenings be used by LEAs as part of a broader process that further evaluates pupil needs and progress, identifies supports for classroom instruction, enables targeted individual intervention as needed, and allows for further diagnosis. The statute specifies that screening instruments identified by the RDRSSP are: (1) not considered an evaluation or diagnostic tool to establish eligibility for special education and related services, and (2) must be appropriate for students in multiple languages. Alternative protocols are established for students for whom a screening instrument does not exist in a language in which the student is fluent.

On December 16, 2024, the RDRSSP approved the following list of screening instruments and corresponding information overviews:

Organization: Amira Learning or HMH

Title: Amira

Grade Levels: Kindergarten, Grade One, and Grade Two

Languages: English and Spanish

Information Overview: <https://www.cde.ca.gov/ci/cl/amirainfooverview.asp>

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Organization: Amplify Education

Title: mCLASS with DIBELS Edition 8 and mCLASS Lectura

Grade Levels: Kindergarten, Grade One, and Grade Two

Languages: English and Spanish

Information Overview: <https://www.cde.ca.gov/ci/cl/mclassinfooverview.asp>

Organization: University of California San Francisco (UCSF) Dyslexia Center

Title: Multitudes

Grade Levels: Kindergarten, Grade One, and Grade Two

Languages: English and Spanish

Information Overview: <https://www.cde.ca.gov/ci/cl/multitudesinfooverview.asp>

Organization: Stanford University, Brain Development and Education Lab

Title: Rapid Online Assessment of Reading (ROAR)

Grade Levels: Grade One and Grade Two

Languages: English only

Information Overview: <https://www.cde.ca.gov/ci/cl/roarinfooverview.asp>

Further, state law requires the governing board of an LEA serving pupils in kindergarten, grades 1, and 2, to adopt at a public meeting, on or before June 30, 2025, one or more screening instruments from the list adopted by the RDRSSP. The screening instrument or instruments adopted shall provide assessments for both English-speaking pupils and non-English speaking pupils, in languages reflecting the primary languages of pupils in the LEA, to the extent assessments in those languages are available.

mCLASS with DIBELS 8 and mCLASS Lectura has a strong research base, validated by decades of literacy studies, and are widely used across districts nationwide for their accuracy in identifying students at risk for reading challenges. It provides real-time, actionable data that allows educators to tailor instruction and interventions based on student needs.

Beginning in 2010, LAUSD began using the latest, updated versions of the DIBELS assessment system, providing reliable data to support early literacy. Elementary teachers have developed an understanding and familiarity with both DIBELS 8 and Lectura, the Spanish-language counterpart, through consistent implementation and professional development over the last 15 years. District educators understand how to administer the assessments, interpret results, and use the data to inform targeted instruction and monitor student progress.

The Division of Instruction engaged District offices and key stakeholders at multiple levels to review the state-approved screening tools and gather feedback, including:

- District departments and offices, including Government Relations, Office of the General Counsel, Multilingual & Multicultural Education Department (MMED), and the Special Education Division (SPED) to ensure statutory compliance and alignment with existing policies.
- The Office of Data and Accountability and Information Technology Services to ensure the feasibility and seamless integration of technology upgrades and enhancements.
- Interventionists, Dyslexia Working Group, and UTLA representatives including the UTLA Elementary Vice President, UTLA Elementary Committee Members, and the UTLA Educational Policy and Curriculum Committee on instructional alignment and usability of potential screeners from teachers.

- Administrators include Assistant Principals, Principals, and the Elementary Principal Organization Cabinet.
- Region leadership, including Administrators of Instruction and Region Coordinators to discuss coherence, efficiency, and effectiveness.
- Parent and community stakeholders, including representatives from the parent advisory committees and literacy advocacy groups, ensure transparency and inclusivity in the decision-making process.

Stakeholder input was overwhelmingly in support of continuing to use mCLASS with DIBELS 8 and mCLASS Lectura as the screening instrument.

Expected Outcomes:

Implementation of the reading difficulties risk screening tool will improve the identification of kindergarten through second grade students potentially at risk for reading difficulties. Screening will be used by educators like other types of formative and summative assessments to inform individualized instruction, measure a pupil's progress, identify pupil learning needs, improve literacy outcomes, and enable parents and educators to discuss pupil needs in a more informed way.

Board Options and Consequences:

A “Yes” vote adopting mCLASS with DIBELS 8 and mCLASS Lectura as the official screening instrument ensures compliance with California Education Code Section 53008 by June 30, 2025.

A “No” vote will delay the District’s adoption of a reading difficulties risk screening instrument by the state-mandated deadline, which could result in non-compliance. Not complying with the screening mandate would violate state law and may also result in higher rates of struggling readers requiring costly remediation.

Policy Implications:

Policy implications include adjustments to interim assessment policy and practices, reclassification criteria, professional development, and instructional policies related to literacy and language arts. The District will create systems as a part of the broader process of utilizing assessment results to inform instruction and intervention.

Budget Impact:

The projected combined annual cost to effectuate the screening of kindergarten through second- grade students in the 2025-26 school year is estimated at approximately \$3.2 million, which includes staff training, administering the screenings, and the purchase of K-2 licenses (approximately 87,200 student licenses) for the screening instrument. The cost of K-2 DIBELS/Lectura licenses is approximately \$784,800, and the cost to deliver initial training by the vendor, Amplify, is \$699,500. Additionally, a three-hour mandatory professional development for teachers is estimated at approximately \$1,548,330. MiSiS enhancements will be needed to track data, the associated cost is \$150,000. The District has received a one-time allocation of approximately \$1.9 million from the State to offset costs related to professional development for administering pupil screenings. District staff will identify alternate funding within existing program budgets to cover the remaining costs for the 2025-26 school year, estimated at \$1.13 million.

Student Impact:

If a pupil is identified as being at risk of having reading difficulties after being screened using an approved screening instrument, the LEA must provide the pupil with support and services, appropriate to the specific

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challenges identified by the screening instrument and other pertinent information about the pupil. The support and services may include any of the following:

1. Evidence-based literacy instruction focuses on the pupil's specific needs.
2. Progress monitoring.
3. Early intervention in the regular general education program.
4. One-on-one or small group tutoring.
5. Further evaluation or diagnostic assessment.

Equity Impact:

Adopting Amplify Education's reading difficulties risk screening instrument ensures that all LAUSD kindergarten through second-grade students, regardless of background or status, have access to screening using evidence-based, culturally, linguistically, and developmentally appropriate instrument to ensure early identification and intervention for reading difficulties.

Component	Score	Score Rationale
Recognition	4	Use of Amplify Education's reading difficulties risk screening instrument actively recognizes and addresses inequities in education by assessing all students, including English Learners, students with disabilities, socio-economically disadvantaged students, homeless, and foster youth.
Resource Prioritization	4	Resources are prioritized in kindergarten to second grade for students identified by the screening as having reading difficulties.
Results	4	The RDRS reading difficulties screening is highly likely to result in closing opportunity gaps by providing equitable access to instructional support, resources, and interventions for historically underserved students.
TOTAL	12	

Issues and Analysis:

State law requires LEAs to provide parents/guardians with information about the screening, including the date (s) of the screening, and the opt-out process (must be completed no later than 15 calendar days before the administration of the screening instrument). Screening results must be provided promptly, and in no more than 45 days after administration, and shall be accompanied by information about how to read the results, and instructional implications, and next steps if a student is at-risk of reading difficulties.

Attachments:

None

Submitted:

04/17/25

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RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,


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